

# Great Eastern Trail

News about America's Great Eastern Trail, offering an extended unity with nature for hikers from Alabama to New York.

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January 30, 2009

## Closing the gap - VA/WV/KY

January 30, 2009. UPDATE!  
A coordinated effort is underway to close the gap in the GET, between the Pine Mountain Trail (VA/KY border), and north/east to meet with the Allegheny Trail (WV) or Appalachian Trail (VA). We need your help!

The mini-core planning team includes Tom Johnson (President of Great Eastern Trail Assoc), Peggy Pings (National Park Service Rivers & Trails Program in WV), Jennifer Wampler (VA Trails Coordinator), Doug Wood (WV Scenic Trails Association and Mary Ingles Trail Blazers), Kim Steika (VA Tech Community Design Assistance Center), Jim Harvey (PATC in Bluefield WV).

Many other key people are involved in developing possible routing alternatives, and all options are on the table. A contacts database has been created of over 150 interested people to keep informed & involved. Lots of phone calls and emails....

There is a sense that it is time to form a Local Trail Club to help shepherd the project along for long-term sustainability, and an organizational meeting is going to be called in Feb or Mar 2009.

June 27-28 2009 will be a Regional Trail Summit at The Breaks Interstate Park. We will review trail routing maps, and have various speakers and break-out sessions, as well as a full day of various field trips on Sunday. It is free registration, lodging/meals/travel on your own.

We have an ambitious timeline to try to identify a primary route by December 2009.

Please let us know if you want to be involved with this project, or know anyone in the "tri-state corner" that might.

You can contact me for more information. Peggy Pings (NPS-RTCA), Outdoor Recreation Planner, mpings at wvu dot edu, 304-293-2941 x2446.

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